

Healing, uplifting soul gardening busts stress

A former **colleague** in a new job **found** she had to **commute** two plus two hours daily, a total of four hours, just to get to her workplace and back, taking three different modes of transportation, leaving home at 7:45 am and returning after 9:00 pm. Initially **distressed** and tired, she soon found a way to boost her **spirits**. In her **modest** home in Delhi, on the rooftop, she began to grow flowering and other plants in pots, **tending** them either before leaving for work or after reaching home late at night. Flowers are **restful** to look at. They have neither emotions nor conflicts, **points out** Sigmund Freud.

The transformation was **revelatory**. No more **sagging** shoulders, no more **frowning**. All smiles and full of information about plant species, their **attributes** and behaviour. Learning their **botanical** and popular names, she began documenting every flower, creating folders that she would **browse** through when tired. She would search online for more information. She found it **therapeutic**, inspiring and creative. Why try to explain **miracles** to your kids when you can just have them plant a garden, asks Robert Brault.

The New York Times reports that in Sweden, there is a growing trend among old and young, to rent or buy a small garden patch, even if postage stamp-size, near their urban **dwelling**. Called **kolonitradgardar**, this **practice** of gaining access to garden allotments **is** said to have contributed a great deal to help them grow fresh produce, connect with nature and community. "The garden programmes were specifically designed to improve the mental and physical health of city **dwellers**," says Fredrick Bjork, lecturer at Malmo University who specialises in environmental history.

Health benefits are **numerous** – getting your hands dirty in the garden boosts **self-esteem**, increases your **intake** of Vitamin D, makes you feel happy and confident, boosts heart health, reduces stress and blood pressure, and you get to grow your own food, fresh and organic.

It is a fulfilling activity that is creative and beautiful.

Hi-rise apartment **complexes** in newly developed residential urban areas like in Gurgaon, NCR, **provide** opportunity for urban dwellers to grow what they like in small garden plots. A couple, i know, visit and work on their patch on weekends and get excited to **potter** around the beds of vegetables and flowers, **harvesting** what they **sow** and bring the **produce** home and share with friends.

"Gardening connects us to life's natural **rhythms**, the gifts of each season, the **wonder** of creation and the natural world. For me, gardening and **gratitude go hand-in-hand**," says Gretchen Champoux, who runs a garden consultation company in Seattle. She views gardens as **sacred** spaces that **assist** her on her spiritual journey.

Gardening is **akin to** worship. You are in close touch with Mother Earth. You are in **divine** partnership with the master creator, working towards **nurturing** and **sustaining** life as you engage in **regenerative** agriculture that is **sustainable**, healing and productive. The earth is a garden, the Lord its gardener,

cherishing all, none **neglected**, says a **verse** in the Adi Granth. House plants are said to recognise their owners from two km away. Plants are **sentient beings**; they respond by **perking up** when the plant owner returns after going out. "The person who planted me is coming back!" they seem to say. Gardens are **enchanted** places, let's enjoy them. **[Practice Exercise]**

- Red/blue coloring of words in the subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

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Vocabulary

1. **Uplifting** (adjective) – inspiring, encouraging, heartening, motivating, reassuring उत्साहवर्धक
2. **Bust** (verb) – break, shatter, smash, destroy, ruin तोड़ना / समाप्त करना
3. **Colleague** (noun) – co-worker, associate, partner, teammate, companion सहकर्मी
4. **Commute** (verb) – travel, journey, trek, ride, go आना-जाना
5. **Distress** (verb) – trouble, upset, worry, torment, agitate कष्ट देना
6. **Spirit** (noun) – mood, morale, attitude, energy, enthusiasm मनोबल / भावना
7. **Modest** (adjective) – humble, simple, unpretentious, plain, moderate साधारण / विनम्र
8. **Tend** (verb) – care, look after, nurture, attend, manage देखभाल करना
9. **Restful** (adjective) – peaceful, calm, relaxing, soothing, tranquil शांतिदायक
10. **Point out** (phrasal verb) – indicate, show, highlight, identify, mention इंगित करना
11. **Revelatory** (adjective) – revealing, enlightening, informative, instructive, explanatory खुलासा करने वाला
12. **Sagging** (adjective) – drooping, sinking, slumping, bending, declining झुकना / ढीला होना
13. **Frowning** (adjective) – showing displeasure or concentration with a wrinkled brow त्योरी चढ़ाना
14. **Attribute** (noun) – quality, trait, feature, characteristic, property गुण / विशेषता
15. **Botanical** (adjective) – plant-based, herbal, floral, phytological, vegetation-related वनस्पति संबंधी
16. **Browse** (verb) – scan through a text, website, or collection of data to gain an impression of the contents.
17. **Therapeutic** (adjective) – healing, curative, remedial, restorative, beneficial उपचारात्मक
18. **Miracle** (noun) – wonder, marvel, phenomenon, rarity, spectacle चमत्कार
19. **Dwelling** (noun) – residence, home, house, abode, habitation निवास स्थान
20. **Kolonitradgardar** (noun) – (Swedish) small rented or owned urban garden plots बगीचे का छोटा टुकड़ा
21. **Dweller** (noun) – inhabitant, resident, occupant, settler, denizen निवासी

22. **Numerous** (adjective) – many, countless, various, abundant, several अनेक / असंख्य
23. **Self-esteem** (noun) – confidence, self-worth, self-respect, dignity, morale आत्म-सम्मान
24. **Intake** (noun) – consumption, absorption, ingestion, uptake, reception सेवन / ग्रहण
25. **Hi-rise** (adjective) – tall, multi-storey, high, towering, skyscraping ऊँची इमारत वाला
26. **Potter** (verb) – tinker, fiddle, loiter, dawdle, move about leisurely धीरे-धीरे घूमना / समय बिताना
27. **Harvest** (verb) – reap, gather, collect, crop, pick फसल काटना / उपज लेना
28. **Sow** (verb) – plant, seed, scatter, propagate, cultivate बीज बोना
29. **Produce** (noun) – crops, harvest, yield, goods, provisions कृषि उपज
30. **Rhythm** (noun) – beat, pattern, tempo, cadence, flow लय / ताल
31. **Wonder** (noun) – amazement, awe, admiration, astonishment, marvel आश्चर्य
32. **Gratitude** (noun) – thankfulness, appreciation, recognition, indebtedness, acknowledgment कृतज्ञता
33. **Go hand-in-hand** (phrase) – accompany, coincide, coexist, match, align साथ-साथ होना
34. **Sacred** (adjective) – holy, divine, blessed, consecrated, spiritual पवित्र
35. **Assist** (verb) – help, aid, support, guide, facilitate सहायता करना
36. **Akin** (to) (adjective) – similar, related, alike, comparable, equivalent समान
37. **Divine** (adjective) – heavenly, godly, sacred, blessed, spiritual दिव्य
38. **Nurture** (verb) – foster, cultivate, nourish, rear, promote पालन-पोषण करना
39. **Sustain** (verb) – maintain, support, uphold, preserve, continue बनाए रखना
40. **Regenerative** (adjective) – restorative, renewing, revitalizing, rejuvenating, refreshing पुनर्निर्माणकारी
41. **Sustainable** (adjective) – viable, renewable, eco-friendly, maintainable, green टिकाऊ
42. **Cherish** (verb) – treasure, value, appreciate, hold dear, prize संजोना
43. **Neglected** (adjective) – ignored, abandoned, disregarded, overlooked, uncared-for उपेक्षित

44. **Verse** (noun) – stanza, poem, line, lyric,
rhyme कविता / छंद

45. **Sentient** (adjective) – conscious, aware,
responsive, perceptive, cognizant चेतन

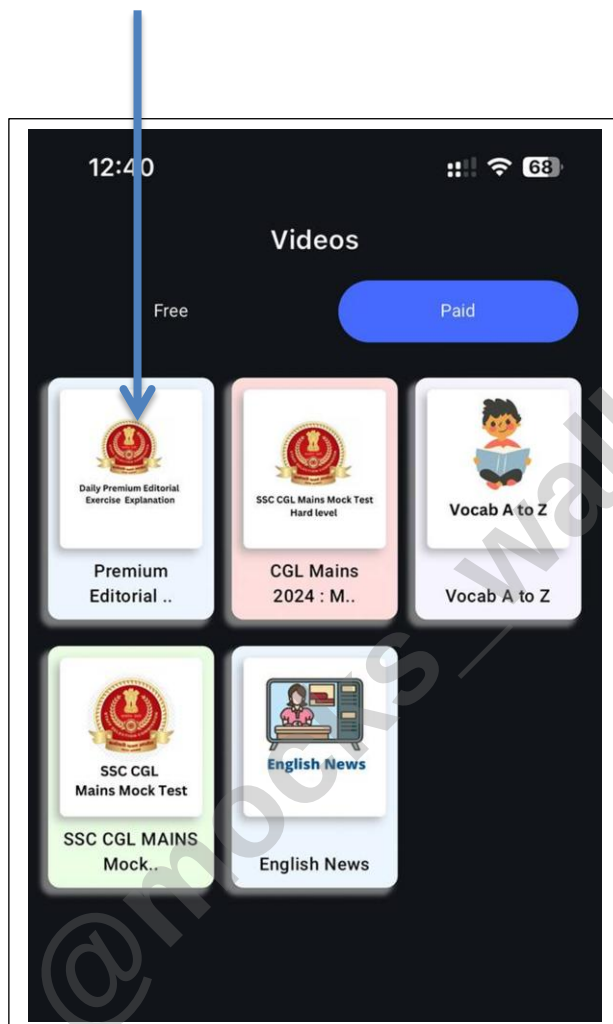
46. **Beings** (noun) – creatures, life forms,
organisms, entities, humans प्राणी

47. **Perk up** (phrasal verb) – brighten, cheer,
revive, energize, freshen up खुश होना /
जीवंत होना

48. **Enchanted** (adjective) – magical,
bewitched, charmed, delightful,
captivating मोहित

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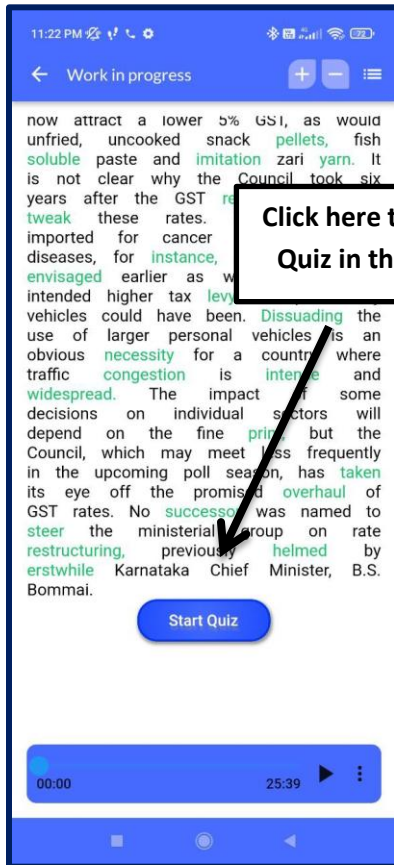
Video solution of Practice Exercise from this Editorial is exclusively available on App.



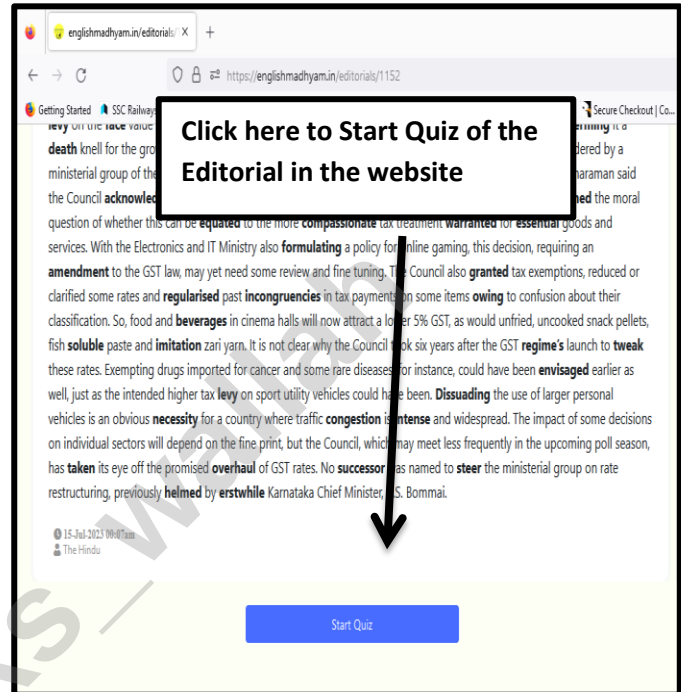
Summary of the Editorial

1. **Stressful Routine:** A woman with a grueling 4-hour daily commute found herself initially exhausted and emotionally drained.
2. **Gardening as Therapy:** To cope, she began rooftop gardening in her Delhi home, finding joy and calm in tending plants.
3. **Positive Transformation:** Her mood and demeanor improved remarkably — no more fatigue or frowning, only enthusiasm and smiles.
4. **Botanical Interest:** She began learning the names and traits of various plants, documenting them in folders and researching online.
5. **Creative Outlet:** Gardening became a source of creativity, therapy, and personal growth for her.
6. **Quote on Gardening's Power:** Robert Brault suggests that planting a garden is better than explaining miracles to children.
7. **Swedish Trend:** In Sweden, urban dwellers rent or buy small garden patches (koloniträdgårdar) to grow food and improve mental and physical well-being.
8. **Mental Health Benefits:** Gardening is seen as a therapeutic intervention for city dwellers, offering emotional and psychological upliftment.
9. **Physical Health Boost:** It enhances self-esteem, increases Vitamin D, improves heart health, reduces stress and blood pressure.
10. **Urban Gardening:** Urban spaces like Gurgaon allow residents to grow vegetables and flowers in community patches.
11. **Community Bonding:** A couple enjoys gardening on weekends, harvesting fresh produce and sharing it with friends.
12. **Spiritual Connection:** Gardening is described as a sacred, spiritual activity that aligns one with nature's rhythms and seasons.
13. **Gratitude and Grounding:** Gardeners express gratitude and feel spiritually connected while nurturing plants.
14. **Plants as Sentient Beings:** Plants are believed to recognize their owners, responding with joy when they return.
15. **Gardens as Enchanted Spaces:** The editorial ends with the idea that gardens are magical, healing places to be cherished and enjoyed.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



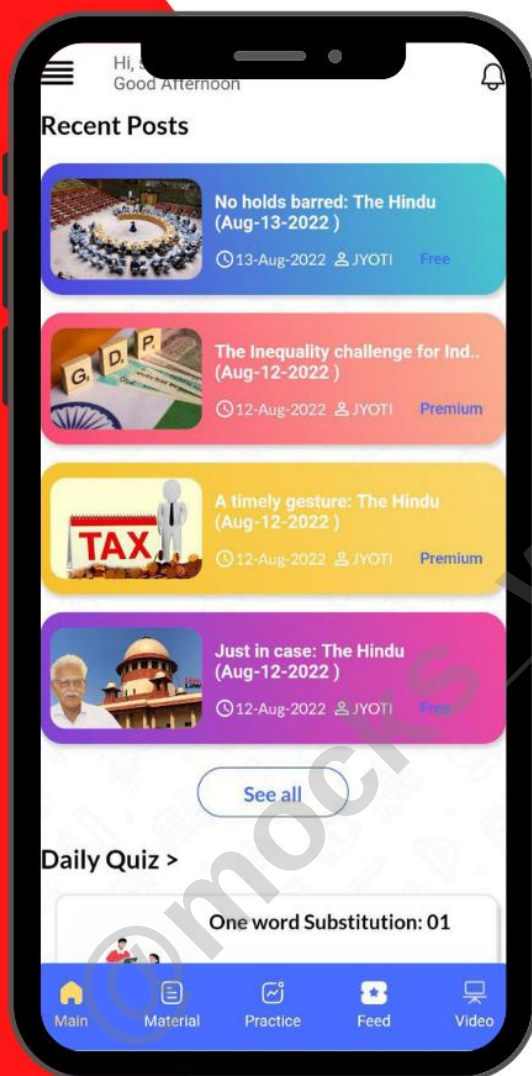
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